

Mitchell S.B. Landers

San Diego, California

MitchellLanders@gmail.com | 805-729-6322 | Website | Google Scholar

EDUCATION

- 2024 **Ph.D., Psychology**, University of Chicago
Advisor: Alex Shaw
Dissertation: "It Takes Three to Tango: The Complexities of Social Valuation and Emotions"
- 2024 **M.A., Psychology**, University of Chicago
Thesis: "Standing on Principle: Moral Reasons Can Excuse Disloyalty to Friends"
- 2017 **B.A., Philosophy**, University of California, Berkeley

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL POSITIONS

- 2026–present **Associate Editor**, *Open Inquiry in Mental Health*, Open Therapy Institute
- 2024–Aug 2026 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, Department of Psychology, University of California, San Diego. Advisors: Michael E. McCullough and Christine R. Harris
- 2018–2024 **Graduate Student Researcher**, Developing Intuitions and Beliefs about Sociality (DIBS) Lab, Department of Psychology, University of Chicago
- 2015–2017 **Research Intern**, Center for Evolutionary Psychology, University of California, Santa Barbara. PI: Leda Cosmides

RESEARCH AREAS

Social emotions; status, reputation, and coalitional psychology; morality and moral judgment; psychometrics and scale development; computational models of social dynamics.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed journal articles

- Landers, M.**, & Shaw, A. (2026). Green-eyed monster or green-eyed mirage? A new procedure for telling when begrudging others' success is or is not envy. *Emotion*, 26(2), 433–449. <https://doi.org/10.1037/emo0001575>
- Landers, M.**, DeScioli, P., Mackiel, A., & Shaw, A. (2026). Standing on principle: How moral principles can excuse disloyalty. *Evolution and Human Behavior*, 47(4), 106883. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.evolhumbehav.2026.106883>
- Landers, M.**, Sell, A., Scrivner, C., & Lopez, A. (2025). The evolutionary logic of anger and hatred: An empirical test. *Evolution and Human Behavior*, 46(6), 106776. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.evolhumbehav.2025.106776>
- Landers, M.***, Sznycer, D.*, & Durkee, P. K. (2024). Are self-conscious emotions about the self? Testing competing theories of shame and guilt across two disparate cultures. *Emotion*, 24(5), 1157–1168. <https://doi.org/10.1037/emo0001321> *Equal first authorship.
- Borráz-León, J. I., Spreitzer, A., Scrivner, C., **Landers, M.**, Lee, R., & Maestripieri, D. (2023). Cortisol reactivity to psychosocial stress in vulnerable and grandiose narcissists: An exploratory study. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 13, 1067456. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2022.1067456>
- Sznycer, D., & **Landers, M.** (2023). When making policy, knowledge of human nature must be supplemented with sound economic analysis: A reply to Johnson and Nettle. *Global Discourse*, 13(2), 225–228. <https://doi.org/10.1332/204378921X16448923157590>
- Landers, M.**, & Sznycer, D. (2022). The evolution of shame and its display. *Evolutionary Human Sciences*, 4, e45. <https://doi.org/10.1017/ehs.2022.43>

Book chapters (published and forthcoming)

Landers, M., & Sznycer, D. (in press). Cross-cultural regularities and variability in the emotion of shame. In U. Hess, S. Hareli, & K. Kafetsios (Eds.), *Research handbook on culture and emotion*. Edward Elgar Publishing.

Landers, M., Sznycer, D., & Al-Shawaf, L. (2024). Shame. In L. Al-Shawaf & T. K. Shackelford (Eds.), *The Oxford handbook of evolution and the emotions* (pp. 145–162). Oxford University Press. <https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780197544754.013.8>

Sell, A., Scrivner, C., **Landers, M.,** & Lopez, A. (2024). The neutralization theory of hatred. In L. Al-Shawaf & T. K. Shackelford (Eds.), *The Oxford handbook of evolution and the emotions* (pp. 163–180). Oxford University Press. <https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780197544754.013.7>

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Landers, M., McCullough, M. E., & Harris, C. R. How FOBE-ic are you? Development and initial validation of the Fear of Being Envied Scale. Under review at *European Journal of Psychological Assessment*.

Landers, M., Schroeder, J., & Shaw, A. Condemned or condoned? When and why third-party forgiveness seems immoral. Under review at *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Landers, M., Harris, C. R., & McCullough, M. E. The competitive-valuation theory of envy (working title).

Landers, M., & Shaw, A. In others' eyes: Envy tracks audience valuation, not personal desire (working title).

Landers, M., Sznycer, D., & Lu, J. Human status tracking as coalition prediction (working title).

Landers, M., & Sznycer, D. Is pride a self-conscious emotion? Testing competing theories of pride across disparate cultures (working title).

FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS, AND HONORS

2024 New Investigator Award (nominee), Human Behavior and Evolution Society

2023 Graduate Travel and Research Fund Award, University of Chicago

2021 Poster Award Finalist, Human Behavior and Evolution Society

2020–2022 Graduate Teaching Fellowship, Department of Psychology, University of Chicago

2018–2024 Center for Early Childhood Research Fellowship, University of Chicago

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS — TALKS

Schroeder, J., **Landers, M.,** & Shaw, A. (November 2026). *Condemned or condoned? When and why third-party forgiveness seems immoral*. Talk accepted for the annual meeting of the Society for Judgment and Decision Making (SJDM), San Diego, CA.

Landers, M. (May 2026). *The evolution of status: Extended formidability and coalition coordination*. Talk accepted at the annual meeting of the Human Behavior and Evolution Society (HBES), Rabat, Morocco.

Landers, M. (February 2026). *The evolution of status: Extended formidability and coalition coordination*. Invited talk presented at the Evolutionary Psychology Preconference, annual meeting of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), Chicago, IL.

Landers, M., & Shaw, A. (June 2025). *What I value or what they do? Audience valuation, not personal desire, predicts malicious envy*. Talk presented in the symposium “Decoding Emotion: New Insights into the Functions of Awe, Shame, Envy, and Tears,” annual meeting of the Human Behavior and Evolution Society (HBES), Atlantic City, NJ.

- Landers, M.,** Sznycer, D., & Durkee, P. (May 2024). *Are self-conscious emotions about the self? Testing competing theories of shame and guilt across two disparate cultures.* Paper presented at the annual meeting of the Human Behavior and Evolution Society (HBES), Aarhus, Denmark.
- Landers, M.,** & Shaw, A. (June 2023). *What I value or what they do? Audience valuation, not personal desire, predicts malicious envy.* Paper presented at the annual meeting of the Human Behavior and Evolution Society (HBES), Palm Springs, CA.
- Landers, M.,** & Shaw, A. (February 2023). *Begrudging what others value, not what I lack: Malicious envy is driven by differential audience evaluations, not personal desire.* Blitz talk, Evolutionary Preconference, annual meeting of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), Atlanta, GA.
- Landers, M.,** Schroeder, J., & Shaw, A. (June 2022). *When forgiveness is not divine: People's evaluations of third-party forgivers.* Paper presented at the annual meeting of the Human Behavior and Evolution Society (HBES), virtual.
- Landers, M.,** Schroeder, J., & Shaw, A. (February 2022). *The moral paradox of forgiveness: When and why forgiveness seems immoral.* Paper presented in the symposium "The Flexibility of Everyday Morality: Political Discourse, Conflict Resolution, and Daily Conversation," annual meeting of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), San Francisco, CA.
- Landers, M.,** Sznycer, D., & Durkee, P. (February 2022). *Testing models of shame and guilt.* Blitz talk, Evolutionary Preconference, annual meeting of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), San Francisco, CA.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS — POSTERS

- Landers, M.,** Sznycer, D., & Durkee, P. (June 2021). *Shame and guilt: Intrapersonal or interpersonal emotions?* Poster presented at the annual meeting of the Human Behavior and Evolution Society (HBES), virtual. Poster Award Finalist.
- Landers, M.,** Sznycer, D., & Durkee, P. (February 2021). *Testing theories of shame and guilt.* Poster presented at the annual meeting of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), virtual.
- Landers, M.,** Shaw, A., & Schroeder, J. (December 2020). *When forgiveness is disloyal.* Poster presented at the annual meeting of the Society for Judgment and Decision Making (SJDM), virtual.
- Landers, M.,** & Shaw, A. (June 2019). *The effects of strength and attractiveness on anger: What matters when?* Poster presented at the annual meeting of the Human Behavior and Evolution Society (HBES), Boston, MA.

SELECTED MEDIA COVERAGE

- PsyPost (January 2026). "New psychology research shows that hatred is not just intense anger." Coverage of Landers, Sell, Scrivner, & Lopez (2025), *Evolution and Human Behavior*.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of Chicago

The Psychology and Neurobiology of Stress — Department of Psychology	Autumn 2022
Developmental Psychology — Department of Psychology	Spring 2022
Social Psychology — Department of Psychology	Spring 2021
The Psychology and Neurobiology of Stress — Department of Psychology	Autumn 2020
Habits of a Free Mind: Psychology for Democracy — Social Sciences Collegiate Div.	Spring 2020

Guest Lecturer, University of Chicago

Social Psychology — Department of Psychology	Spring 2021
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MENTORING

Graduate Student Peer Mentor, University of Chicago

Hayes Whorton	2023
Rowland Linder	2022–2023
Ana Godinez	2020–2022

EDITORIAL SERVICE AND REVIEWING

Associate Editor, *Open Inquiry in Mental Health*, Open Therapy Institute (2026–present). Manage peer review, manuscript handling, editing, and production for the journal.

Ad hoc reviewer: *Evolution and Human Behavior*; *Evolutionary Behavioral Sciences*; *The British Journal for the Philosophy of Science*

PUBLIC WRITING & RESEARCH SOFTWARE

Public writing. Draft and edit articles translating behavioral research for general audiences, including contributions to *Psychology Today*.

WTR-Bench (in development). Implemented a deterministic item generator for 3,600 items across six counterbalanced forms, with 13 tests of item construction and consistency. Empirical validation and model evaluation are planned. github.com/msblanders/wtr-bench

METHODOLOGICAL AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical modeling: mixed-effects/multilevel models; structural equation modeling; Bayesian estimation; bootstrap inference. Expert in R (tidyverse, lavaan, brms, ggplot2).

Psychometrics: item generation, exploratory and confirmatory factor analysis, reliability, and convergent and discriminant validity assessment.

Computational modeling: agent-based simulation of social dynamics (status, coalitions, emotions); game-theoretic modeling.

Programming: R (expert); Python (working proficiency); JavaScript/Three.js; GDScript; Git.

AI/LLM methods: evaluation design; reproducible item generation and counterbalancing; prompt design; AI-text detection methodology.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP)	2021–present
Midwestern Psychological Association (MPA)	2020–present
Society for Judgment and Decision Making (SJDM)	2020–present
Human Behavior and Evolution Society (HBES)	2018–present

REFERENCES

Alex Shaw

Department of Psychology, University of Chicago
ashaw1@uchicago.edu

Daniel Sznycer

Department of Psychology, Oklahoma State University
daniel.sznycer@okstate.edu

Leda Cosmides

Department of Psychological and Brain Sciences, University of California, Santa Barbara
cosmides@ucsb.edu